

Domain V — Performing Internal Audit Services

Principle 14 — Conduct Engagement Work

Content classification: Requirements and implementation guidance below are paraphrased from the supplied pages. Suggested controls, audit procedures, red flags, and illustrative findings are practical application content, not additional IIA requirements.

Principle 14 — Overview

Internal auditors carry out the engagement work program to achieve the engagement objectives. They gather information, perform analyses, evaluate findings, develop recommendations or collaborate with management on action plans, and form supported conclusions.

The work should establish a clear connection between the engagement objectives, evaluation criteria, evidence, findings, and conclusions.

Standard	Title	Main purpose
14.1	Gathering Information for Analyses and Evaluation	Obtain relevant, reliable, and sufficient information.
14.2	Analyses and Potential Engagement Findings	Compare the actual condition against evaluation criteria.
14.3	Evaluation of Findings	Assess causes, effects, significance, and priority.
14.4	Recommendations and Action Plans	Develop practical responses to findings and their underlying causes.
14.5	Engagement Conclusions	Form an overall judgment supported by the engagement results.
14.6	Engagement Documentation	Maintain complete, reviewable evidence supporting the work and results.

Standard 14.1 — Gathering Information for Analyses and Evaluation

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must gather information that meets three characteristics:

Characteristic	Meaning
Relevant	Supports the engagement objectives, falls within its scope, and contributes to the results.

Characteristic	Meaning
Reliable	Is factual and current. Reliability is strengthened through direct collection, independent sources, corroboration, and effective controls over the source system.
Sufficient	Provides an adequate basis for analysis and evaluation and enables an informed, competent person to repeat the work and reach the same conclusions.

Internal auditors must:

- Evaluate the relevance, reliability, and sufficiency of the information used to support potential findings and conclusions.
- Apply professional skepticism when assessing information reliability.
- Determine whether additional information is needed when the available evidence does not adequately support the engagement findings.
- Determine whether the inability to obtain relevant evidence should itself be identified as a finding.

Considerations for Implementation

Information gathering should be connected to specific work program steps and engagement objectives. Suitable methods include:

- Interviewing or surveying individuals involved in the activity.
- Observing processes and conducting walkthroughs.
- Obtaining independent confirmations.
- Inspecting documents, inventory, equipment, or other physical evidence.
- Accessing organizational systems to observe activities or extract data.
- Working with system users and administrators to obtain information.

Auditors should consider whether to examine a complete population or use a representative sample. Data analysis tools may support full-population or targeted testing. When sampling is used, the selection method should support the intended purpose and the conclusions drawn.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Work programs identifying relevant information-gathering procedures.
- Records identifying information sources, collection dates, and periods covered.
- Documented explanations of why the information is sufficient for the analysis performed.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Alignment between requested evidence and engagement objectives.
- Reliability and independence of information sources.
- Completeness and accuracy of extracted data.
- Coverage of the period and population under review.
- Corroboration of management explanations.

- Appropriateness of sampling methods.
- Resolution of contradictory or missing information.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Reliance on unverified management explanations	Unsupported or biased conclusions.
Incomplete data populations	Relevant transactions or exceptions remain undetected.
Outdated information	Conclusions do not reflect the period or condition under review.
Unrepresentative samples	Results are inappropriately generalized.
Unresolved contradictory evidence	Findings misstate the underlying facts.

4. Controls — Suggested

Suggested control	Type
Evidence request list linked to work program steps	Preventive
Reconciliation of extracted data to source-system totals	Detective
Recording sources, extraction parameters, dates, and periods	Preventive
Corroboration of significant explanations through independent evidence	Detective
Supervisor review of evidence sufficiency before conclusions are finalized	Detective
Additional testing or revised evidence collection where gaps are identified	Corrective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Audit procedure	Required evidence
Map information collected to engagement objectives and work program steps.	Approved work program, evidence request list, indexed workpapers.
Evaluate the source and reliability of information supporting significant judgments.	Source records, system descriptions, independent confirmations.
Reconcile extracted populations to source totals and investigate differences.	Extraction parameters, record counts, control totals, reconciliation results.
Check that evidence covers the relevant period and scope.	Transaction dates, reporting periods, population boundaries.
Assess sample selection and the limits of any conclusions drawn from it.	Population description, sampling rationale, sample list, exclusions.

Audit procedure	Required evidence
Review unresolved evidence gaps and decisions on additional work or potential findings.	Follow-up requests, alternative procedures, supervisor review, documented decisions.

6. Red Flags

- Spreadsheets with no identifiable source.
- Unexplained differences between source totals and audit datasets.
- Management selects all items examined.
- Significant conclusions rely solely on interviews.
- Evidence falls outside the engagement period.
- Contradictory records are excluded without explanation.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- The audit team relied on an unreconciled transaction extract, leaving population completeness unverified.
- A significant conclusion was supported only by management representations.
- The sampling method did not support the population-wide conclusion reported.
- Missing evidence was neither addressed through additional procedures nor evaluated for its effect on the engagement.

8. Professional References

- Standard 14.1 — Gathering Information for Analyses and Evaluation.
 - Standard 4.3 — Professional Skepticism.
 - Standard 13.6 — Work Program.
 - Standard 14.2 — Analyses and Potential Engagement Findings.
 - Standard 14.6 — Engagement Documentation.
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Standard 14.2 — Analyses and Potential Engagement Findings

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must analyze relevant, reliable, and sufficient information to develop potential engagement findings.

The analysis must compare:

- **Criteria:** The established expectations or evaluation benchmarks.
- **Condition:** The actual state of the activity, determined from the information and evidence gathered.

A difference between criteria and condition represents a potential finding that must be recorded and further evaluated.

Internal auditors must:

- Determine whether initial analyses adequately support potential findings.
- Exercise due professional care when deciding whether additional analysis is necessary.
- Adjust the work program and obtain chief audit executive approval when additional analyses are required.
- Provide assurance in the engagement conclusion regarding process effectiveness when no difference exists and no further analysis is needed.

For advisory services, gathering evidence to develop findings may not be necessary, depending on the agreement with relevant stakeholders.

Considerations for Implementation

Analytical techniques may include:

- Testing process accuracy or effectiveness.
- Ratio, trend, or regression analysis.
- Comparing actual results with budgets, forecasts, or previous periods.
- Examining relationships between financial and nonfinancial information.
- Comparing performance across organizational units.
- Benchmarking against comparable external organizations.

Auditors should use appropriate technology to improve analytical coverage and efficiency.

When deciding whether to perform additional procedures, consider the engagement risk assessment, potential significance, strength of existing evidence, availability of reliable information, and costs relative to benefits.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Workpapers documenting analyses, tools, populations, and sampling methods.
- Cross-references between work programs, analyses, and final communications.
- Documentation supporting the final communication.
- Evidence of supervisory review.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Suitability of evaluation criteria.
- Accuracy of the documented condition.
- Reliability of analytical calculations and assumptions.
- Investigation of exceptions and unusual patterns.
- Approval of necessary work program changes.
- Support for both adverse findings and positive assurance.
- Alignment of advisory work with agreed objectives.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Inappropriate criteria	Acceptable performance is incorrectly reported as deficient, or weaknesses are missed.
Incorrect analytical logic	False exceptions or undetected issues.
Unexplained variances	Significant conditions remain insufficiently investigated.
Premature conversion of exceptions into findings	Unsupported reporting.
Unsupported “no issues” conclusions	False assurance about process effectiveness.

4. Controls — Suggested

Suggested control	Type
Documentation of criteria before evaluating results	Preventive
Independent review of formulas, scripts, and analytical assumptions	Detective
Exception register recording investigation and disposition	Detective
Approval workflow for changes to the work program	Preventive
Cross-references connecting conclusions to completed analyses	Preventive
Reperformance of selected significant calculations	Detective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Audit procedure	Required evidence
Verify that each analysis uses relevant evaluation criteria.	Criteria register, applicable policies, approved benchmarks.
Reperform selected calculations and assess analytical assumptions.	Source data, formulas, scripts, parameters, results.
Trace potential findings to evidence of the actual condition.	Exception records, transaction support, observation notes.
Review explanations for significant variances and assess corroboration.	Management explanations, supporting documents, additional tests.
Check whether additional analysis resulted in approved work program changes.	Revised work programs, change rationale, approvals.
Review conclusions where no findings were reported.	Completed tests, results, coverage assessment, conclusion workpaper.

6. Red Flags

- Criteria selected after results are known to justify a preferred conclusion.
- Spreadsheet formulas containing unexplained manual overrides.
- Significant variances accepted without supporting evidence.
- Exceptions removed from analysis without documented reasons.
- Additional procedures performed without the required approval.
- A “satisfactory” conclusion based only on the absence of detected exceptions.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- Analytical comparisons used inconsistent periods, making the reported variance unreliable.
- Potential findings were reported before exceptions were adequately investigated.
- Required additional analysis was not reflected in an approved work program.
- The engagement conclusion did not explain how completed testing supported positive assurance.

8. Professional References

- Standard 14.2 — Analyses and Potential Engagement Findings.
 - Standard 13.4 — Evaluation Criteria.
 - Standard 13.6 — Work Program.
 - Standard 14.1 — Gathering Information for Analyses and Evaluation.
 - Standard 14.3 — Evaluation of Findings.
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Standard 14.3 — Evaluation of Findings

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must evaluate each potential finding to determine its significance.

They must collaborate with management to:

- Identify root causes when possible.
- Determine potential effects.
- Evaluate the significance of the issue.

Risk significance must consider the likelihood of occurrence and the impact on the organization's governance, risk management, or control processes.

When significant risk exposure is identified, it must be documented and communicated as a finding. Other risks must be assessed for reporting based on the circumstances and established methodologies.

Each finding must be prioritized using the methodology established by the chief audit executive.

Considerations for Implementation

Finding evaluation should explain the connection between the observed condition, the applicable criteria, the underlying causes, and the resulting exposure.

Auditors should:

- Investigate why the difference exists, including deeper contributing factors.
- Work with management to understand underlying causes.
- Quantify impact where feasible, identifying estimates and assumptions.
- Evaluate existing controls and the remaining residual risk.
- Consider risk tolerance and other relevant organizational factors.
- Apply consistent prioritization across engagements.
- Write findings clearly and support significance judgments with documented evidence.

A finding template may contain:

Element	Description
Criteria	What should happen.
Condition	What was found.
Root cause	Why the condition exists, when identifiable.
Effect	Actual consequences or potential exposure.
Significance and priority	The assessed importance of the finding.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Workpapers explaining the evaluation criteria.
- Finding records containing the relevant elements and priorities.
- Documentation supporting materiality, risk tolerance, and cost-benefit considerations.
- Approved methodologies and templates.
- Final engagement communication documentation.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Completeness of finding evaluation.
- Root cause analysis and management input.
- Distinction between actual loss and potential exposure.
- Assessment of existing and compensating controls.
- Likelihood, impact, and residual risk.
- Consistency of finding priorities.
- Communication of significant risks.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Symptoms treated as root causes	Corrective actions fail to prevent recurrence.
Unsupported impact estimates	Findings exaggerate or understate exposure.
Inconsistent prioritization	Management directs resources to the wrong issues.
Effective compensating controls ignored	Residual risk is overstated.
Significant risks omitted	Decision-makers lack important information.

4. Controls — Suggested

Suggested control	Type
Standard finding template covering criteria, condition, cause, effect, and priority	Preventive
Defined significance methodology reflecting likelihood and impact	Preventive
Root cause discussions with relevant management	Detective
Review of calculations, assumptions, and exposure estimates	Detective
Calibration review of ratings across engagements	Detective
Escalation of unresolved significant risk assessments	Corrective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Audit procedure	Required evidence
Review potential findings for documented evaluation and disposition.	Potential-finding register, evaluation workpapers.
Assess whether root causes are supported rather than assumed.	Interviews, process analysis, corroborating records.
Recalculate quantified impacts and inspect estimation assumptions.	Calculations, source records, estimation methods.
Evaluate how existing controls affect residual risk.	Control design assessments, operating-effectiveness tests.
Compare assigned priorities with the approved methodology.	Rating criteria, likelihood and impact assessments, review sign-offs.
Confirm that significant risks were communicated as findings.	Final report, relevant interim communications, distribution records.

6. Red Flags

- Every finding receives the same rating without analysis.
- “Human error” is used as the root cause without further investigation.
- Potential exposure is described as a confirmed loss.
- Risk ratings change without new evidence or documented rationale.
- Management disagreement results in removal of a significant finding.
- Recurring issues receive actions that address only immediate symptoms.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- Finding priorities were assigned without reference to the established significance methodology.
- The stated root cause was unsupported by the documented analysis.
- Financial exposure calculations mixed confirmed losses with estimated future risks.
- Existing controls were not evaluated when assessing residual risk.

- A significant risk identified during fieldwork was omitted from the final communication without a supported rationale.

8. Professional References

- Standard 14.3 — Evaluation of Findings.
- Principle 4 — Exercise Due Professional Care.
- Standard 14.2 — Analyses and Potential Engagement Findings.
- Standard 14.4 — Recommendations and Action Plans.
- Standard 14.5 — Engagement Conclusions.

Standard 14.4 — Recommendations and Action Plans

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must determine whether to develop recommendations, request management action plans, or collaborate with management to agree on actions.

These actions are intended to:

- Resolve differences between the criteria and the actual condition.
- Reduce identified risks to an acceptable level.
- Address the root cause of the finding.
- Improve the activity under review.

Recommendations developed by internal auditors must be discussed with the management of the activity.

When auditors and management disagree on recommendations or action plans, the established methodology must allow both parties to explain their positions and rationale and provide a process for resolution.

Considerations for Implementation

Discussions should involve management with the authority to make or oversee the necessary changes.

Possible approaches include:

- Recommending a specific corrective action.
- Presenting several reasonable options.
- Asking management to investigate alternatives and propose a response.

- Establishing multiple actions for one finding where necessary.

Auditors should assess the feasibility, reasonableness, costs, benefits, and expected risk reduction of proposed actions.

Where disagreement persists, the chief audit executive should work with senior management to facilitate resolution. Each party's formal position may be attached to the final communication or made available upon request.

Management remains responsible for implementing corrective actions.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Finding workpapers containing recommendations or action plans.
- Records of management discussions.
- Assessments of action feasibility and expected effectiveness.
- Documentation supporting the final communication.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Alignment of actions with findings and root causes.
- Expected reduction in risk exposure.
- Feasibility and proportionality of proposed responses.
- Involvement of authorized management.
- Clear implementation responsibility.
- Resolution of disagreements.
- Preservation of management ownership.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Generic recommendations	Actions do not address the identified weakness.
Actions address symptoms only	Findings recur.
Unrealistic or disproportionate solutions	Implementation is delayed or abandoned.
Involvement of management without authority	Agreed actions cannot be delivered.
Internal audit assumes implementation responsibility	Accountability becomes unclear and objectivity may be affected.

4. Controls —

Suggested control	Type
Finding-to-action mapping showing the cause and risk addressed	Preventive
Feasibility and cost-benefit review	Preventive
Confirmation of the management owner's authority	Preventive
Documented disagreement-resolution process	Corrective
Defined deliverables and completion evidence for each action	Preventive
Review of whether proposed actions reduce risk to an acceptable level	Detective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence —

Audit procedure	Required evidence
Trace each proposed action to the relevant finding, cause, and exposure.	Finding records, recommendation/action mapping.
Evaluate whether the action would reasonably address the underlying problem.	Process analysis, proposed control changes, rationale.
Review feasibility and proportionality.	Resource estimates, dependencies, cost-benefit assessment.
Verify discussion with management authorized to oversee implementation.	Meeting records, management responses, authority records.
Examine disagreements and how they were handled.	Both parties' positions, escalation records, resolution documentation.
Confirm that implementation responsibility remains with management.	Action plans, ownership records, final communication.

6. Red Flags

- Actions state only “improve controls” or “ensure compliance.”
- Training is proposed for a system-design weakness without further measures.
- Repeated findings receive the same unsuccessful response.
- No one has authority to deliver the agreed change.
- Management rejects an action without an alternative or documented resolution.
- Internal audit is named as the owner of an operational corrective action.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- Recommendations did not address the supported root cause.
- Proposed actions were accepted without evaluating their feasibility.
- The action plan did not explain how the identified exposure would be reduced.
- Disagreement with management was not processed through the established methodology.

- Responsibility for implementing an operational control was incorrectly assigned to internal audit.

8. Professional References

- Standard 14.4 — Recommendations and Action Plans.
- Standard 9.3 — Methodologies.
- Standard 14.3 — Evaluation of Findings.
- Standard 15.1 — Final Engagement Communication.
- Standard 15.2 — Confirming the Implementation of Recommendations or Action Plans.

Standard 14.5 — Engagement Conclusions

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must develop an engagement conclusion that summarizes results in relation to:

- The engagement objectives.
- Management's objectives.

The conclusion must express professional judgment about the overall significance of the findings considered together.

For assurance engagements, the conclusion must include a judgment on the effectiveness of the governance, risk management, and/or control processes reviewed. It must also acknowledge where processes are effective.

Considerations for Implementation

The chief audit executive's methodology may establish a rating scale. Examples in the supplied guidance include satisfactory, partially satisfactory, needs improvement, and unsatisfactory.

These are examples; the standard does not prescribe one universal rating scale.

Conclusions should consider the combined significance of findings and explain relevant context. An issue may be significant for a particular activity without having the same significance for the organization overall.

Advisory engagement conclusions should align with the agreed objectives and scope.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- A workpaper documenting the basis for the overall conclusion.
- A conclusion statement in the final engagement communication.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Coverage of engagement objectives.
- Relationship to management's objectives.
- Combined significance of findings.
- Balance between weaknesses and effective practices.
- Consistency with supporting workpapers.
- Appropriate use of ratings.
- Alignment with the engagement's scope and service type.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Conclusion does not address the objectives	Users cannot determine what the engagement established.
Findings assessed only individually	A broader pattern of weakness is overlooked.
Overall rating conflicts with evidence	Management receives misleading assurance.
Positive results are omitted	Reporting becomes unbalanced.
Conclusion extends beyond tested scope	Users assume assurance over unexamined activities.

4. Controls — Suggested

Suggested control	Type
Objective-by-objective conclusion assessment	Preventive
Documented analysis of aggregated findings	Detective
Defined rating methodology where ratings are used	Preventive
Supervisor review of consistency between evidence and conclusion	Detective
Review of wording against scope and testing coverage	Detective
Separate conclusion guidance for assurance and advisory engagements	Preventive

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence —

Audit procedure	Required evidence
Map the conclusion to each engagement objective.	Objectives, work program, conclusion workpaper.
Assess how findings were considered collectively.	Findings summary, thematic analysis, significance assessment.
Compare the overall rating with the established methodology.	Rating definitions, supporting rationale, review records.
Verify that judgments on effectiveness are supported by testing.	Control evaluations, test results, evidence references.
Check that effective processes are appropriately acknowledged.	Positive test results, final conclusion.
Assess whether the conclusion stays within the agreed scope.	Scope statement, coverage records, documented limitations.

6. Red Flags

- A satisfactory conclusion accompanies unresolved significant weaknesses without explanation.
- The conclusion repeats individual findings without an overall judgment.
- Ratings are calculated mechanically without professional judgment.
- The report claims effectiveness in areas that were not tested.
- Advisory work is presented as broader assurance than the work supports.
- Effective processes are excluded from the conclusion despite supporting evidence.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- The conclusion did not address one of the approved engagement objectives.
- The combined significance of related findings was not evaluated.
- The overall rating lacked a documented basis.
- The conclusion extended beyond the activities and period examined.
- An assurance conclusion failed to acknowledge effective processes identified during testing.

8. Professional References

- Standard 14.5 — Engagement Conclusions.
 - Standard 13.3 — Engagement Objectives and Scope.
 - Standard 14.3 — Evaluation of Findings.
 - Standard 14.6 — Engagement Documentation.
 - Standard 15.1 — Final Engagement Communication.
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Standard 14.6 — Engagement Documentation

1. Standards & Guidance

Requirements

Internal auditors must document information and evidence supporting the engagement results.

The documented analyses, evaluations, and supporting information must enable an informed, prudent internal auditor—or another similarly informed and competent person—to repeat the work and derive the same results.

The standard requires:

- Internal auditors and the engagement supervisor to review documentation for accuracy, relevance, and completeness.
- The chief audit executive to review and approve engagement documentation.
- Retention of documentation in accordance with relevant laws, regulations, and the policies and procedures of the internal audit function and the organization.

Considerations for Implementation

Workpapers organize the engagement evidence, support supervision, demonstrate the basis for results, and help evaluate the quality of internal audit work.

Engagement documentation should include:

- Engagement date or period.
- Engagement risk assessment.
- Objectives and scope.
- Work program.
- Procedures, analyses, and information sources.
- Engagement results.
- Identification of those performing and supervising the work.
- Evidence of communication to appropriate parties.

Workpapers may follow the structure of the work program and use cross-references to connect evidence, tests, findings, and conclusions.

Common Workpapers

Workpaper	Purpose
Planning documentation	Records the basis and direction of the engagement.
Process maps, flowcharts, or narratives	Explains how the activity operates.
Interview summaries and surveys	Records information obtained from relevant individuals.
Risk and control matrix	Connects risks, controls, and planned testing.
Testing and analysis records	Shows procedures performed and results obtained.
Finding and conclusion workpapers	Supports professional judgments and reported results.
Proposed follow-up work	Identifies subsequent verification needs.
Final communication and management responses	Records communicated results and responses.

Basic Workpaper Format

- Unique index or reference number.
- Title identifying the activity reviewed.
- Engagement date or period.
- Scope of work performed.
- Purpose of obtaining and analyzing the information.
- Information sources.
- Population description, sample size, and selection method.
- Procedures, analysis, results, and conclusion.
- Preparer's identity.
- Reviewer's identity and review notes.
- Cross-references to relevant supporting records.

Examples of Evidence of Conformance

- Workpapers showing work performed under the established methodology.
- Internal quality assessment results validating compliance with documentation and supervision policies.

2. Audit Focus Areas

- Completeness and accuracy of engagement files.
- Ability to reproduce analyses and conclusions.
- Traceability from reported findings to evidence.
- Documentation of populations and sampling.
- Evidence of preparation, supervision, review, and approval.
- Appropriate retention and protection of records.

- Consistency between the work program and documented work.

3. Risks

Risk	Potential consequence
Unsupported findings or conclusions	Reported results cannot be substantiated.
Missing analytical details	Another competent reviewer cannot repeat the work.
Incomplete review evidence	Errors and gaps remain unresolved.
Broken references or missing attachments	Evidence cannot be located or verified.
Premature deletion or unauthorized alteration	Audit records lose integrity or become unavailable.

4. Controls — Suggested

Suggested control	Type
Standard templates with required documentation fields	Preventive
Unique indexing and consistent cross-referencing	Preventive
Review and approval workflow with identifiable sign-offs	Detective
Resolution tracking for review comments	Corrective
Controlled access, version history, and protected storage	Preventive
Retention schedule aligned with applicable requirements	Preventive
Periodic quality review of completed engagement files	Detective

5. Audit Procedures and Required Evidence — Suggested

Audit procedure	Required evidence
Check completed files against the documentation methodology.	Documentation policy, file index, completed checklist.
Trace reported findings and conclusions to supporting workpapers.	Final communication, finding records, evidence references.
Reperform selected analyses using the documentation alone.	Source data, formulas or scripts, sampling details, test instructions.
Verify reviewer and chief audit executive review and approval records.	Sign-offs, approval records, review history.
Assess whether significant review comments were resolved.	Review notes, responses, amended workpapers, closure records.
Inspect record retention arrangements against applicable requirements.	Retention policy, storage records, authorized disposal records.

Audit procedure	Required evidence
Review access and version controls over engagement documentation.	Access permissions, version history, change records.

6. Red Flags

- Workpapers state “checked” without identifying what was examined.
- Findings reference evidence that is missing or inaccessible.
- Samples cannot be reproduced from the recorded selection method.
- Review approvals are recorded while significant comments remain unresolved.
- Original evidence is overwritten by revised working files.
- Retention periods are applied without an approved basis.
- Engagement files contain conclusions but no supporting analyses.

7. Common Findings — Illustrative Examples

- Workpapers did not contain enough detail to reproduce the testing performed.
- Reported findings were not linked to identifiable supporting evidence.
- Documentation lacked evidence of the required review and approval.
- Sampling records omitted the population, sample size, or selection method.
- Records were retained inconsistently with the applicable retention policy.
- Significant review comments lacked documented resolution.

8. Professional References

- Standard 14.6 — Engagement Documentation.
 - Standard 5.2 — Protection of Information.
 - Standard 12.1 — Internal Quality Assessment.
 - Standard 12.3 — Oversee and Improve Engagement Performance.
 - Standard 13.6 — Work Program.
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